AUTO TICKET CLASSIFICATION USING FLOW DESIGNER

1. Brainstorming & Ideation Phase

The Brainstorming and Ideation Phase is the first important stage in the development of the project titled “Auto Ticket Classification using Flow Designer.” The main purpose of this phase is to understand the existing problem in school IT helpdesk operations and to generate practical ideas for solving it through automation. In a school environment, students and staff may submit different types of IT-related requests, including login issues, password problems, network connectivity problems, software issues, hardware complaints, and access-related requests. When these tickets are handled manually, the support team has to spend considerable time reading each request, identifying its category, and deciding how it should be processed.

The project team began the brainstorming process by studying the difficulties associated with manual ticket classification. A support ticket normally contains a short description entered by the student or staff member. The description may vary from one user to another, even when the underlying problem is similar. Therefore, the helpdesk staff may have to examine every ticket individually before assigning a category. This repetitive activity can consume time and may also result in inconsistent classification. The team identified this manual effort as an area where workflow automation could provide a useful improvement.

During the ideation process, several possible approaches were considered. One possible approach was to use complex scripting to analyze ticket descriptions and automatically determine their categories. Another possibility was to use machine-learning techniques to classify requests. However, these approaches could increase development complexity and maintenance requirements. Since the project was intended to demonstrate a practical ServiceNow automation solution, the team decided to focus on a low-code or no-code approach that could be configured and maintained by administrators without depending heavily on custom programming.

After considering the available ServiceNow capabilities, Flow Designer was selected as the central technology for the proposed solution. Flow Designer allows administrators to create automated processes using triggers, conditions, actions, and notifications. This made it suitable

for building an automated ticket-classification workflow. The team planned a flow in which the system would respond when a relevant ticket event occurred, examine the information in the ticket, apply predefined logic, update the required fields, and communicate the result to the user.

Another important idea developed during brainstorming was the use of structured ticket information. Instead of depending entirely on free-text descriptions, the ticket form could provide predefined choices to guide users. The team considered the use of dependent choices, where one selection controls the available options in another field. This approach can make the form easier to understand and can reduce incorrect combinations of values. It also provides the helpdesk with more consistent information for processing requests.

The team also discussed the importance of making the ticket creation process simple for students. A school IT helpdesk may receive requests from users with different levels of technical knowledge. Therefore, the form should not require users to understand complicated technical classifications. The idea was to present clear choices and allow the system to handle the underlying classification logic. This would make the application more user-friendly while still providing structured data to the support team.

Automated communication was another idea identified during the brainstorming stage. Once a ticket is created, the caller should receive confirmation that the request has been successfully submitted. Manually sending an acknowledgement for every ticket would create additional work for the helpdesk team. Therefore, the proposed solution includes an automated email notification. The notification can inform the caller that the ticket has been created and can provide useful information such as the ticket reference or request details.

The team also considered the expected impact of automation on helpdesk operations. Automatic classification can reduce repetitive manual work and allow support staff to spend more time on resolving technical problems. Consistent classification can also make it easier to organize and track tickets. In addition, automated notifications can improve communication because the caller receives immediate confirmation without waiting for a staff member to respond manually.

Security and data integrity were included in the initial ideas because the application handles ticket information. The team recognized that not every user should have permission to modify

workflow configuration or administrative settings. Appropriate access controls should therefore be maintained. The system should also prevent invalid or incomplete information from being used in the automated process. These considerations helped ensure that the proposed solution would not focus only on functionality but also on reliability and controlled access.

The brainstorming process was carried out in a phased and structured manner. First, the existing problem was identified. Next, possible automation approaches were discussed. The advantages of using ServiceNow Flow Designer were then considered in relation to the project requirements. The team decided that a predefined workflow with conditions, field updates, dependent choices, and automated notifications would provide a suitable implementation approach. This decision established a clear direction for the next phases of the project.

The team also considered future expansion while developing the initial idea. The solution should be capable of supporting additional categories and subcategories if the school helpdesk requirements change. New notification rules, assignment processes, service-level agreements, and other workflow actions could be added later. Designing the initial solution with maintainability in mind would make future enhancements easier and would avoid the need to rebuild the entire application.

At the end of the Brainstorming and Ideation Phase, the project concept was clearly established. The proposed system would use ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate the classification of IT support tickets in a school environment. It would combine structured ticket fields, dependent choices, workflow conditions, automated updates, and email notifications. The overall idea was to reduce manual effort, improve consistency, simplify the user experience, and provide faster communication to callers.

The outcome of this phase provided the foundation for the detailed requirement analysis. The team now had a clear understanding of the problem, the expected users, the proposed technology, and the major features of the solution. The ideas generated during brainstorming could therefore be converted into functional and non-functional requirements in the next phase. This ensured that the project would move from a general concept to a clearly defined and implementable ServiceNow solution.